Title: Evidence Scope and Conflicting Results in Retrieval-Augmented Generation: A Demonstration Study

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Abstract: This fictional demonstration paper discusses why retrieval-augmented generation results may differ across evaluation settings. It describes a synthetic comparison in which retrieval augmentation improves traceability when source passages are relevant, but does not guarantee factual answers when evidence is incomplete or contradictory. The examples are invented for testing citation-aware literature synthesis.

Methods

The illustrative analysis contrasts a closed evidence set containing supporting passages with a second set containing incomplete and conflicting passages. No human participants, external datasets, or measured product evaluation are involved.

Findings

Answers are easier to audit when each claim points to a retrieved passage. However, a citation alone does not establish that the passage entails the claim. Conflicting passages should be presented with their differing conditions rather than silently collapsed into one conclusion. If no relevant passage is retrieved, the system should abstain or ask for a narrower question.

Limitations

The material is fictional and is not a real empirical study. Its purpose is to exercise metadata parsing, hybrid retrieval, conflict handling, and citation validation in the demo project.